MERGED MENTORSHIP DASHBOARD
FEATURE RESEARCH & SPECIFICATION

For a 1:1 Entrepreneur LMS Mentorship Module

Consolidated from three research sources into a single authoritative specification

1. Scope, Method & Design Philosophy

1.1 Research Scope

This consolidated research surveys mentorship functionality across two overlapping categories of platforms:

- Dedicated mentoring software: Mentornity, MentorcliQ, Qooper, Mentorgain, PushFar, MentorPRO, Mentorink, MentorCruise, Together Platform, Chronus, Mentorloop, RQ Mentorship
- Incubator/accelerator program management platforms: Incubators Platform (Bloomfilter), MentorDeck, Catalyzer, InzpireU, Educate-Me, Startup Science

The findings are consolidated into a feature set specifically for a fixed 1:1 mentor–mentee model (one mentor permanently paired with one mentee for the programme duration), rather than the "mentor network / self-service booking" model used by some accelerators. That distinction is critical: it prioritises continuity and relationship depth over discovery and browsing.

1.2 Core Research Findings

Across nearly every platform reviewed, mentoring software converges on five functional pillars: matching, scheduling, structured session tracking, goal/milestone tracking, and reporting/analytics. Incubator-specific platforms add a layer of funding management and performance monitoring. Accelerator-focused tools emphasise mentor profiles with expertise tagging, calendar integration, session tracking, and engagement reporting — because programmes are answerable to funders and boards.

For structured 1:1 programmes, the sharpest guidance is: **stage-based matching, pre-session context delivery, session documentation tools, impact tracking, programme-level reporting, and integration with cohort management workflows** — because these features ensure mentorship produces measurable outcomes that can be reported to stakeholders.

1.3 Design Principles for a 1:1 Model

Because the model is a fixed 1:1 pairing (not a bookable network), the dashboard does not need mentor-discovery or browsing features. Instead, weight the design toward:

- Relationship continuity — one shared space per pair, not a marketplace
- Structured accountability — every session has a record, not just a calendar entry
- Bidirectional visibility — both mentor and mentee see the same goals and history
- Escalation path to programme staff — clear way to flag a struggling pairing to an admin (no self-service "switch mentors" option)
- Deep context sharing — mentors have full visibility into the mentee's entire journey
- Long-term relationship tracking — tools supporting relationships lasting 3–12 months
- Accountability loops — strong task tracking and follow-up so mentees act on advice
- Personalized learning paths — curriculum and resources tailored to the mentee's stage and challenges

1.4 Core Philosophy

The most effective mentorship platforms treat the relationship as a structured system rather than just a connection. The key is giving mentors context, giving mentees accountability, and giving programme managers visibility into progress.

2. Mentor Dashboard — Recommended Features

2.1 Mentee Relationship Overview

- Mentee profile: business idea/venture summary, sector, stage, location, contact info, team size, funding status, key challenges
- Relationship timeline: start date, programme cohort, expected end date
- At-a-glance status: last session date, next scheduled session, overdue flag
- Match score visibility: expertise fit, stage alignment, working-style compatibility
- Lifecycle stage indicator: current startup phase (e.g. ideation → validation → product → go-to-market)

2.2 Pre-Session Context & Preparation (Highest-Impact Feature)

Mentors should never walk into sessions blind. This is the single most critical mentor-side capability.

- Mentee Snapshot Card: current lifecycle stage, startup progress percentage, key metrics (e.g. MRR, team size)
- Session Countdown: timer/notification showing time until next scheduled session
- Last Session Summary: auto-generated recap of what was discussed, tasks assigned, and completion status
- Open Tasks Status: overdue, completed, or in-progress items from previous sessions
- Current Blockers: mentee-submitted challenges or questions they want to focus on
- Pre-session prep view: mentee's open goals, last session's action items, and any documents the mentee has shared

2.3 Session Management & Workflow

- Calendar/scheduling with availability sync (Google Calendar, Outlook) so sessions can be centrally scheduled and missed sessions minimized
- Integrated video-call launch (Zoom / Teams / Meet) directly from the dashboard
- Session logging: date, duration, mode (in-person/virtual), topics covered
- Structured session notes template (not a blank textbox) — prompts such as: what was discussed, key advice given, decisions made, blockers identified, follow-up actions
- Agreed next steps / action items captured per session automatically alongside notes
- Task assignment tool: assign 1–3 specific, actionable tasks to the mentee with deadlines and priority levels
- No-show / reschedule flagging — mentor can mark a missed session so the programme is informed
- Next-session scheduling prompt before ending the current session
- Confirm attendance / mark completed

2.4 Goal & Milestone Tracking

- View of the mentee's business/venture goals (ideally SMART-formatted)
- Ability to co-set or endorse goals with the mentee, not just observe them
- Milestone check-off with mentor sign-off/comment
- Visual progress indicator per goal (on track / at risk / stalled)

- Progress Timeline: visual journey through programme milestones, curriculum completion, and key achievements
- Academy/LMS Integration: visibility into which courses, modules, or resources the mentee has completed
- Milestone Achievements: badges or certifications tied to startup development stage

2.5 Communication & Engagement

- In-platform messaging/chat with the mentee (keeps relationship history in one place rather than scattered across WhatsApp/email)
- Document/resource sharing tied to the relationship (business plans, financials, pitch decks)
- Automated nudges: system-generated reminders to mentees about upcoming sessions, overdue tasks, or suggested resources
- Resource library access: curated materials (templates, guides, case studies) that mentors can recommend and share directly
- Optional video-call integration launched from the dashboard

2.6 Task & Resource Assignment

- Assign a task/homework item to the mentee between sessions, with a due date
- Attach or recommend curriculum/course content from the LMS relevant to what the mentee is struggling with — a real differentiator versus generic mentoring software
- Ability to attach recommended resources to specific goals or blockers

2.7 Feedback & Private Reflection

- End-of-session or periodic mentee feedback form (how useful was this session)
- Ability for the mentor to log private reflection/concerns (visible to programme admin only, not the mentee) — early warning of a struggling venture or mismatched pairing
- View of mentee-submitted post-session ratings and testimonials

2.8 Impact Measurement & Recognition

- Personal dashboard: sessions completed, hours contributed, mentee milestones achieved during the relationship
- Impact Score: cumulative score based on sessions conducted, tasks completed by mentees, and milestones achieved
- Engagement Analytics: graphs showing session frequency, response rates, and mentee progress over time
- Simple engagement summary exportable for the mentor’s own records (many volunteer mentors need this for employer CSR/volunteering reporting)
- Certificate of Contribution: downloadable recognition for programme completion or outstanding mentorship

2.9 Profile & Matching Preferences

- Expertise Profile: detailed bio, areas of expertise, industries, stages worked with, availability (hours/month), past exits or achievements
- Matching Preferences: ability to set preferences for mentee stage, industry, location, or specific challenges they want to help with
- Match Score Visibility: see how well-matched they are with their assigned mentee

3. Mentee Dashboard — Recommended Features

3.1 My Mentor

- Mentor profile: background, expertise areas, sector experience, industries, stages worked with
- Direct contact/messaging channel
- Session history with that one mentor (clean single timeline, not a multi-mentor log)
- Match confirmation view with match-score explanation
- Ability to request re-matching if the pairing is not working (escalation to programme staff)

3.2 Goal Setting & Progress Planning

- SMART Goal Framework: structured goal-setting tool (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound)
- Personal goal-setting workspace tied to the venture (idea validation, revenue targets, registration, funding readiness, etc.)
- Milestone Tracker: visual progress bar showing completion of key milestones (e.g. “Complete customer discovery,” “Launch MVP,” “Secure first 10 customers”)
- Lifecycle Stage Indicator: clear display of current startup phase with guidance on what to focus on next
- Ability to update progress against a milestone (self-report), which the mentor can then confirm/comment on
- Visual timeline of the venture’s growth over the mentorship period — powerful artifact at programme graduation and for donor storytelling
- Individual progress dashboard highlighting completed milestones, pending tasks, and feedback from the mentor

3.3 Session Preparation & Management

- View upcoming session; request/propose a session time within mentor’s availability
- Pre-Session Checklist: prompts to prepare (e.g. “Upload pitch deck,” “Complete TAM analysis,” “List top 3 challenges”)
- Session History: archive of past sessions with notes, tasks assigned, and resources shared
- View past session notes and agreed action items (read access to what the mentor logged, with ability to add own comment/reflection)
- Confirm attendance / mark completed
- Upcoming Sessions Calendar with reminders and preparation materials
- One-click video-call join for scheduled sessions
- Question Submission form: submit specific questions or challenges before sessions so the mentor can prepare

3.4 Tasks & Action Items

- Clear task list assigned by the mentor, with due dates, priority, and completion status (pending / in progress / completed / overdue)
- Ability to mark tasks as complete, upload evidence/deliverables (e.g. draft business plan, registration certificate, customer interview notes), and request feedback
- Overdue Task Alerts: notifications for tasks past deadline to maintain accountability

3.5 Learning Integration & Resource Library

- Direct links to LMS courses/modules the mentor has recommended, based on identified gaps
- Ability to see how mentorship advice maps to specific course content (closes the loop between “learn” and “apply, with mentor guidance”)

- Curated Content Library: mentorship handbooks, templates (business model canvas, financial projections), case studies, industry reports
- Personalized Recommendations: rule-based or AI suggestions for resources based on current stage, challenges, or completed tasks
- LMS Integration: view of enrolled courses, modules completed, and certifications earned within the broader LMS

3.6 Communication & Resources

- In-platform chat with mentor
- Shared document space (mentee can upload business documents for mentor review)
- Video-call launch from the dashboard
- Program Manager Access: ability to contact programme coordinators for support, re-matching requests, or technical issues

3.7 Progress Analytics & Self-Reflection

- Progress Dashboard: visual charts showing session attendance, task completion rate, goal progress, and curriculum completion
- Milestone Achievements: badges or certificates earned, tied to startup development stages
- Self-Reflection Prompts: periodic check-ins asking mentees to reflect on what's working, what's not, and what they need more help with
- Mentee Confidence Growth tracking: self-reported confidence in key areas (pitching, fundraising, product strategy) before and after the programme

3.8 Feedback & Voice

- Ability to rate/give feedback on sessions (usefulness, relevance, likelihood to recommend)
- Escalation channel to flag to programme staff if the pairing isn't working, sessions aren't happening, or they need reassignment — critical in a fixed 1:1 model
- Periodic Match Reviews: after 4–6 sessions, evaluate the match and provide feedback

3.9 Profile & Matching Preferences

- Startup Profile: comprehensive profile including industry, stage, revenue (if any), team size, funding status, and key challenges
- Mentor Matching Preferences: desired mentor expertise, working style (hands-on vs advisory), and availability

4. Shared / Relationship-Level Features (Both Mentor & Mentee See)

4.1 Shared Workspace

- Interactive workspace scoped to that one relationship only — collaboration, goal-setting, progress tracking, and calendar sync
- Joint session calendar
- Shared goal/milestone board (single source of truth, not two separate lists)
- Shared document repository for the relationship
- Shared session notes: both parties can view and (where appropriate) contribute for transparency and accountability
- Action Item Agreement: jointly agreed-upon tasks with clear ownership and deadlines

4.2 Notifications & Reminders

- Automated reminders for upcoming sessions, overdue action items, and unconfirmed session logs
- Multi-channel alerts: email, SMS, WhatsApp, or in-app notifications
- Automated follow-ups: post-session summaries sent to both parties with tasks and next steps
- Eliminate scheduling conflicts and missed follow-ups through system-driven nudges

4.3 Feedback & Evaluation (Shared)

- Post-session ratings: both mentor and mentee rate session quality and relevance
- Periodic match reviews after 4–6 sessions

4.4 Privacy & Security

- Confidentiality agreements: digital acknowledgment of confidentiality expectations
- Data protection: secure storage of sensitive startup information with role-based access controls

5. Programme / Admin Panel Features

Even though the primary focus is mentor and mentee dashboards, every platform reviewed makes clear that a 1:1 model still needs a robust admin layer — especially in a donor-funded programme where reporting matters. This layer sits above both dashboards and is the integration point with existing MEL (Monitoring, Evaluation & Learning) and Asset Register systems.

5.1 Pairing & Matching Management

- Pairing/assignment tool: manual pairing is standard for 1:1 models; optionally support a matching algorithm or let entrepreneurs express preferences
- Algorithmic matching capability: skills-based, stage-aligned, and working-style-compatible matching with admin override
- Onboarding workflow: guided setup for both mentors and mentees including profile completion, expectation setting, and first-session scheduling
- Re-matching workflow: ability to reassign mentors if a pairing isn't working
- Match Satisfaction monitoring: track separate ratings from mentor and mentee on how well-matched they feel

5.2 Relationship Health Dashboard

- Visualizing mentor-mentee relationship health to identify thriving or at-risk pairings
- Flags for pairs with no recent session activity, no-shows, or stalled goals
- Stalled Match Alerts — automated triggers when:
  - No sessions in 45+ days
  - Task completion <40% for 2+ weeks
  - Satisfaction scores <3.0 for 2+ sessions
- Action: trigger programme manager intervention
- Active Pair Rate: percentage of assigned pairs that have had a session in the last 30 days (healthy range: 90%+)

5.3 Cohort & Programme Management

- Cohort management: organizing mentees by intake/cohort/location, consistent with how MEL and Asset Register systems already segment programme data

- View all mentor-mentee pairs, session status, and engagement metrics in one place
- Custom rubrics/forms for session structure so mentors across the programme document consistently (directly useful for M&E needs)

5.4 Programme-Level Reporting & Analytics

- Goal completion rates, mentor-mentee engagement statistics, session frequency and participation metrics
- Overall progress relative to defined mentorship objectives
- Export for compliance/donor reporting
- Impact Reporting: aggregate data for stakeholders (total sessions, task completion rates, founder progress)
- Session counts, milestone completions, and relationship-health flags are exactly the indicators an M&E system would want to ingest

5.5 Integration Hub

- Connect with LMS, CRM, video conferencing, calendar, and communication tools (Slack, Teams)
- Integration point with existing MEL frontend and Asset Register systems for Emerge Livelihoods

6. Metrics for Tracking Mentor–Mentee Interaction Quality

To track interaction quality, combine quantitative engagement data (what they're doing) with qualitative sentiment data (how they feel about it). The strongest programmes layer multiple metrics to get a complete picture of relationship health and impact.

6.1 Engagement Metrics (Interaction Frequency & Consistency)

Baseline indicators that the relationship is active.

- Session Frequency: average number of sessions per month or per programme phase. Healthy range: 1–2 sessions per month for 1:1 entrepreneur mentorship. Red flag: no sessions in 4+ weeks.
- Session Attendance Rate: percentage of scheduled sessions that actually happen. Track no-shows, cancellations, and reschedules. Healthy range: 85%+.
- Time Between Sessions: average days between consecutive sessions. Healthy range: 14–30 days. Red flag: gaps >45 days without programme manager intervention.
- Messaging Activity: number of messages exchanged between sessions. Healthy range: 3–10 messages per week.
- Login/Platform Activity: how often both parties log into the mentorship portal. Low activity from either side can predict drop-off.
- Average Session Duration: time spent in each session. Healthy range: 45–60 minutes. Red flag: consistently <30 min suggests lack of depth.

6.2 Goal & Task Completion Metrics (Accountability)

These show whether interactions are translating into action.

- Goal Completion Rate: percentage of mentee-defined goals achieved within agreed timelines. Healthy range: 60–80% of short-term goals.
- Task Completion Rate: percentage of mentor-assigned tasks completed on time. Healthy range: 70%+. Red flag: <50% suggests misalignment or lack of follow-through.
- Time to First Milestone: days from programme start to first significant mentee achievement (e.g. completed customer discovery, launched MVP). Faster time indicates effective early guidance.

- Milestone Progression Rate: how quickly mentees move through programme phases (validation → product → go-to-market). Compare against cohort averages to identify stalled pairs.

6.3 Relationship Quality Metrics (Sentiment & Satisfaction)

These capture the human dimension of the relationship.

- Post-Session Satisfaction Score: after each session, both parties rate session usefulness (1–5), relevance to current challenges, and likelihood to recommend the format. Healthy range: 4.0+ average.
- Relationship Quality Score: periodic survey (every 4–6 sessions) asking: “How well does your mentor/mentee understand your challenges?”, “How comfortable are you being honest with them?”, “Do you feel supported?”. Healthy range: 80%+ positive responses.
- Trust & Psychological Safety Index: qualitative assessment of whether mentees feel safe sharing vulnerabilities and mentors feel respected. Measured through open-ended survey questions or structured interviews.
- Mentee Confidence Growth: self-reported confidence in key areas (pitching, fundraising, product strategy) before and after the programme. Healthy range: 20–40% increase.

6.4 Outcome Metrics (Business & Career Impact)

For entrepreneur programmes, these are the ultimate measures of mentorship ROI.

- Startup Progress Indicators: revenue growth, customer acquisition milestones, product launches/iterations, funding raised. Track month-over-month or phase-over-phase.
- Skill Assessment Improvement: pre- and post-programme assessments on key entrepreneurial competencies (business model design, customer discovery, financial planning). Healthy range: measurable improvement in 3+ competency areas.
- Programme Completion Rate: percentage of mentor-mentee pairs that complete the full programme duration. Healthy range: 80%+. Red flag: >30% dropout suggests matching or support issues.
- Net Promoter Score (NPS): “How likely are you to recommend this mentorship programme to another entrepreneur?” Healthy range: 50+ NPS.

6.5 Match Health Metrics (Pairing Effectiveness)

These help identify whether the 1:1 pairing is working or needs intervention.

- Match Satisfaction Score: separate ratings from mentor and mentee. Healthy range: both parties 4.0+/5. Red flag: one party <3.0 indicates potential re-match need.
- Expertise Alignment Score: how well the mentor’s expertise matches the mentee’s current challenges (rated by both). Healthy range: 80%+ agreement.
- Working Style Compatibility: assessment of communication styles, availability, and expectations alignment. Measured through periodic check-ins or surveys.
- Re-Match Request Rate: percentage of pairs requesting re-assignment. Healthy range: <10%. Red flag: >20% suggests matching or onboarding issues.

6.6 Programme Health Metrics (Aggregate View)

For programme managers tracking multiple pairs.

- Active Pair Rate: percentage of assigned pairs with a session in the last 30 days. Healthy range: 90%+.
- Stalled Match Alerts: pairs meeting any of the red-flag criteria listed in 5.2 — trigger programme manager intervention.
- Feedback Response Rate: percentage of participants completing post-session or periodic surveys. Healthy range: 70%+. Low response can hide underlying issues.

6.7 Recommended Tracking Cadence

Metric Type	Frequency	Who Tracks
Session frequency & attendance	Weekly	Automated (platform)
Task completion rate	Weekly	Automated + Mentee self-report
Post-session satisfaction	After each session	Both parties (survey)
Goal completion rate	Monthly	Programme manager
Relationship quality score	Every 4–6 sessions	Programme manager (survey)
Startup progress indicators	Monthly or per milestone	Mentee self-report + Programme manager
Match satisfaction	Every 4–6 sessions	Both parties (survey)
Stalled match alerts	Real-time	Automated (platform)

7. Feature Checklist (Quick Reference)

Feature	Mentor	Mentee	Shared / Admin
Profile & relationship overview	Yes	Yes	—
Session scheduling	Yes	Request / confirm	Calendar sync
Pre-session context / prep view	Yes (critical)	Checklist / questions	—
Structured session notes	Author	View + comment	—
Action items / tasks	Assign	Complete + upload evidence	—
Goal / milestone tracking	Co-set, endorse	Set, self-report progress	Aggregate reporting
In-platform messaging	Yes	Yes	—
Document sharing	Yes	Yes	Shared repository
LMS course linking	Recommend	Access	—
Session / pair feedback	Yes	Yes	Aggregate
Escalation to programme staff	Private notes to admin	Flag pairing issue	Receive & act
No-show / activity flagging	Yes	—	Health monitoring
Personal impact / contribution view	Yes	Venture growth timeline	—
Pairing / assignment tool	—	—	Yes
Relationship health dashboard	—	—	Yes
Cohort-level reporting for donors	—	—	Yes
Video-call integration	Yes	Yes	—
Notifications & reminders	Yes	Yes	Automated system-wide

8. Recommended Implementation Priority

8.1 Dashboard Build Priority

Based on impact and dependency order across all three research sources:

1. **Start with Pre-Session Context** — highest-impact feature; mentors never walk in blind.
2. **Build Session Workflow** (notes, tasks, next-session scheduling) — creates accountability.

3. **Add Progress Tracking** — mentors and mentees need to see momentum (goals, milestones, LMS progress).
4. **Integrate Communication Tools** — reduce friction in staying connected (chat, document sharing, video).
5. **Layer in Impact Measurement & Feedback** — keep mentors engaged by showing their value; capture post-session ratings.
6. **Build Admin / Relationship Health Layer** — stalled-match alerts, cohort reporting, MEL integration.

8.2 Metrics Implementation Priority

1. **Start with Engagement Metrics** (session frequency, attendance, time between sessions) — easiest to automate and provide early warning signals.
2. **Add Task & Goal Tracking** — directly ties mentorship to actionable outcomes.
3. **Layer in Post-Session Ratings** — quick, low-friction feedback after each call.
4. **Build Relationship Quality Surveys** — deeper sentiment checks every 4–6 sessions.
5. **Connect to Startup Progress** — the ultimate measure of mentorship ROI for entrepreneurs.

9. Key Differentiators for This 1:1 LMS Module

Because the product is built for exclusive 1:1 pairings inside an existing LMS (not group or on-demand mentoring), emphasise:

- Deep Context Sharing: mentors have full visibility into the mentee's entire journey, not just session-by-session snapshots.
- LMS Course Linking as a first-class feature: mentors recommend specific courses from the LMS library; mentees see the direct link between advice and learning — a real differentiator versus generic mentoring software.
- Long-Term Relationship Tracking: tools that support relationships lasting 3–12 months.
- Accountability Loops: strong task tracking, evidence upload, and follow-up so mentees act on advice.
- Escalation Path: fixed pairings need a clear, low-friction way for either party (or the system) to flag problems to programme staff.
- MEL / Donor Reporting Integration: session counts, milestone completions, and relationship-health flags feed the existing M&E systems.

10. Sources Consulted

- Incubators Platform (Software Advice) — incubator/accelerator platform review
- MentorDeck — mentorship software guide for accelerators
- Mentornity — entrepreneurship mentoring software
- Qooper — mentoring programme tracking & reporting
- Mentorgain — session tracking feature page
- MentorPRO — goal-focused mentoring platform
- Mentorink — mentoring software overview
- RQ Mentorship — mentorship software feature page
- Catalyzer — accelerator/incubator management platform
- InzpireU — accelerator mentoring/accountability platform
- Educate-Me — accelerator/incubator platform
- Startup Science — comparison of startup mentorship platforms
- Softr — mentor-mentee matching tool template
- PeopleManagingPeople / Gartner Peer Insights — mentoring software comparisons
- Chronus, MentorcliQ, Together Platform, Mentorloop, Tenthousandcoffees — platform feature references

- LinkedIn and industry best-practice sources on mentorship metrics and relationship health

— End of Merged Research Document —